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FAR EASTERN DEPARTMENT

1949

CHINA

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F 7984

Registry Number F7984/10127/10

FROM Dr. Tuan, Chinese Embassy, &c
Mr. Scarlett.

No.

Dated 30 May 1949
31 May 1949

Received in Registry

F: China

Status of Formosa.

Requests that the Foreign Office take steps to correct the statement made by Mr. Bowles in the House of Commons on 5th May that Formosa is a part of Japan.

Last Paper

F7841

References

(Print)

(How disposed of)

(Action completed)

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(Minutes)

I do not think we want to get into a wrangle with the Chinese Embassy about the legal status of Formosa. Chinese of all factions choose to regard Formosa as being legally as well as geographically already an integral part of China, and nothing we might say would influence their opinion.

If no objection is seen, I can take ~~some~~ an early opportunity to indicate to Dr. Tuan the general legal basis for our views on Formosa, as set out in my minute on F 2120/10127/10, ~~and~~ I think that to reply to this letter would merely invite a protracted and futile correspondence.

F. S. Tomlinson
3rd June, 1949.

Mr Certaine should not reply to this piece of impertinence in writing - I fancy it is for this reason that the Embassy, doubtless on instructions, have framed the communication as they have. Bryah means have a laugh with Dr Tuan if you get the chance. I don't propose to reply to the subject.

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F 7984

Chinese Embassy,
49, Portland Place, W.1.

30th May, 1949.

Dear Mr. Scarlett,

Recent utterances concerning Formosa made by certain Parliamentary leaders notably the Deputy-Chairman, Mr. Bowles, who said on May 5th: "Formosa is a part of Japan and is not really China" have given rise to misgivings. We, therefore, feel it necessary to point out the historical fact that Formosa has always been a part of Chinese territory and populated by Chinese. Though after the Sino-Japanese war in 1895 Formosa was ceded to Japan, as a result of the Treaty of Shimonoseki, its restoration to China after the second World War could only reaffirm the continuity of that historical fact. We therefore hope you will be good enough to adjust this historical perspective, especially when interpellation in the House of Commons should require a clarification from the Foreign Office.

Sincerely yours,

M. L. Tuan

(M.L. Tuan).

P.W. Scarlett, Esq., C.M.G.
Far Eastern Department,
Foreign Office,
S.W. 1.